

ICOMOS Burra Charter principles

What this tool produces · *A formal Statement of Cultural Significance detailing the aesthetic, historic, scientific, and social values of the site, accompanied by a binding conservation policy.*

G1 · Proof of Impact

G3 · Proof of Anchoring

Dimensions

Heritage

Social / User

Spatial

Preparing the workshop · *ICOMOS Burra Charter principles*

G1 · Proof of Impact

Why this tool matters

Listening to the whispers of the past embedded in mortar and stone, recognizing that preserving a place is fundamentally about preserving the living soul, identity, and continuity of the community that loves it.

Evidence we produce

A formal Statement of Cultural Significance detailing the aesthetic, historic, scientific, and social values of the site, accompanied by a binding conservation policy.

Duration & Material

Duration · 3 to 6 months for research and consultation

Material · The Burra Charter guidelines, historical archives, community engagement protocols. (Note: The mechanics and context of this tool are standard heritage conservation practices derived from the foundational literature referenced in the corpus titles)

Reference case

The Burra Charter (adopted by Australia ICOMOS and influential globally) fundamentally shifted heritage management from a purely monumental approach to a values-based model. By defining cultural significance through the lens of social and spiritual attachments, the charter guides the adaptive reuse of complex sites such as former industrial landscapes and indigenous lands ensuring that physical development respects and retains the deep memory of the place.

Suggested agenda · Brief (10 min) > Method walk-through (15 min) > Animation canvas (60-90 min) > Harvest (20 min)

Cultural significance · understand · conserve · interpret

Duration
3 to 6 months for research and consultation

Aesthetic value

sensory · visual · sound

Historic value

evidence of past

Scientific value

research potential

Social value

community attachment

Spiritual value

sacred · symbolic

Statement of significance precedes any conservation policy.

Harvesting our *learnings*

After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.

What inspires me

Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember

How to apply it here

Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints

What we need to be autonomous

Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure

Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.